

Teacher:	Ray Joshua Balingkit	**Subject:**	Media Studies
Week:	13 (Term 1)	**Year:**	10–11
Link:		**Cover:**	

LESSON OVERVIEW

What should students know/do by the end of this week's lessons?

Students will analyse magazine-cover conventions and the relationship between design, content promises and audience interests. They will examine how the masthead, main image and cover lines establish hierarchy and magazine identity. Students will then create and annotate an original cover for a stated audience, justify their choices and revise a feature using feedback against the brief.

End-of-Week Assessment/Check: How will you know they got it?

Teacher questioning, class discussion, analysis of worked examples and the completed independent activities. Check that students use accurate terminology, select specific evidence and explain how a choice creates meaning or addresses an audience. Review the written, visual or practical work alongside its annotations, and use the final checks in both lessons to identify the next skill requiring practice.

LESSON SLOTS - TUESDAY AND FRIDAY

Lesson	Date	Learning Objective	The Lesson Flow	Differentiation
1	17 November 2026	By the end of this lesson, students will be able to analyse magazine-cover conventions and explain how they address a defined audience.	**H:** Display two contrasting teacher-selected magazine covers. Ask what interests each cover promises to satisfy and which design or language features suggest its intended readership. **ID:** Introduce the masthead, main image, cover lines, colour palette, typography, price and issue information. Explain how layout creates hierarchy and how a cover communicates a magazine's identity. Discuss audience interests and lifestyle as evidence-based inferences, avoiding unsupported stereotypes about who must read a particular magazine. **WD:** Annotate a fictional student-technology magazine cover. Identify the most prominent elements and explain how the main image and cover lines work together to	**Support:** Provide a labelled cover, a conventions checklist and an audience-evidence grid. Model one connection between a cover line and a reader interest. Encourage students to focus on the main image and headline before analysing smaller details. **Extension:** Students identify a possible secondary audience or a tension between two cover elements. They explain how changing one convention could alter the magazine's identity or perceived readership.



			promise useful content. Compare a contrasting cover and distinguish features common to the form from choices specific to its audience. **YD:** Students annotate two covers and produce an audience profile supported by at least three visible features. They write one comparative paragraph explaining how language and design address different interests. Pairs check that every audience claim is linked to evidence rather than an assumption about the reader. **C:** Ask students to distinguish the magazine's title from a cover line and explain the purpose of each. Check that the analysis considers hierarchy and audience appeal as well as identifying conventions.	
2	20 November 2026	By the end of this lesson, students will be able to create and annotate a magazine cover that uses conventions to address a stated audience.	**H:** Present a brief for a fictional magazine aimed at students with a shared interest. Ask what content promise should be most visible and how a reader could recognise the magazine on a crowded shelf or screen. **ID:** Explain how a cover design translates an audience brief into a main image, masthead, cover lines and a clear visual hierarchy. Discuss readable typography, limited competing elements and consistency of tone. Review original or teacher-provided assets and remind students that annotations must justify actual choices in their design. **WD:** Sketch two possible layouts for a fictional school-creativity magazine. Compare their	**Support:** Provide a cover template, an approved image bank and a short audience brief. Use an annotation frame linking choice, purpose and audience. Help students establish one clear focal point before adding secondary cover lines. **Extension:** Students create a second layout or adapt the cover for a different readership. They explain the trade-off between preserving magazine identity and changing the language or design to address a new audience.



			hierarchy and choose one against the brief. Model a specific annotation explaining how a cover line promises relevant content and how its position helps the intended reader notice it. **YD:** Students create a paper or digital cover with a masthead, main image and at least three purposeful cover lines. They annotate four choices using the audience brief, then exchange designs for a conventions-and-audience check. Students revise one feature and explain why the change improves the cover. **C:** Collect the design, annotations and brief. Ask students to justify the most important cover choice and identify evidence that it addresses the intended audience. Check that the annotations explain the visible design rather than describing an unrealised intention.	
3				Support: Extension:
4				Support: Extension:

MATERIALS NEEDED FOR THE WEEK

- GCSE Media Studies for AQA (Heinemann): Unit 4 Magazines: Analysing magazine covers and describing audiences
- Teacher computer, display screen and speakers where audio is used
- Age-appropriate teacher-selected extracts or teacher-prepared fictional media texts
- Prepared analysis worksheet, evidence grid or production brief
- Paper, pencils, storyboard or design templates, and whiteboard markers
- Classroom computers and save folders; camera or approved image bank when required
- Lesson success criteria and teacher observation checklist



END-OF-WEEK REFLECTION

- What worked well?

- What flopped or confused students?

- What needs to be re-taught or adjusted next week?